

43 Making suggestions

You can use the modal verb “could” to offer suggestions. “Could” is not as strong as “should.” It communicates gentle advice.

 **New language** “Could” for suggestions

Aa Vocabulary Advice

 **New skill** Making suggestions

43.1 KEY LANGUAGE “COULD” FOR SUGGESTIONS

“Could” is often used to suggest a solution to a problem. It introduces possibilities but not preferences.

I hate my car!



Well, **you could** get a new one!

“Could” means that the action is a possibility; a choice that might solve the problem.



43.2 FURTHER EXAMPLES “COULD” FOR SUGGESTIONS

You could study science in college.



We could learn English in Canada next year.



They could buy a bigger house with a yard.



You could get a job at that new restaurant in town.



43.3 HOW TO FORM “COULD” FOR SUGGESTIONS

SUBJECT

You

“COULD”

could

VERB

get

REST OF SENTENCE

a new car.

“Could” is a modal verb, so it doesn't change with the subject.

The main verb goes in its base form.